

Board: 2

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: North

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6♠

Declarer: East

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 5 3
♥ 6 5 2
♦ Q 10 5 2
♣ K Q 9 3

♠ A 10
♥ A K Q J 9
♦ K 4 3
♣ 7 5 2



♠ K Q J 7 4
♥ 10 3
♦ J 8 7
♣ J 10 4

♠ 9 8 6 2
♥ 8 7 4
♦ A 9 6
♣ A 8 6

West	North	East	South
	1♥	Pass	2♥
Pass	3♣	Pass	4♥
All Pass			

4♥ by North

HELP SUIT GAME TRY. Partner has 8 points and the ♣A and decides that is enough to bid game.

North plays 4♥. East leads the ♠K.

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Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 2 : Total = 4

You win the ♠A and pull trumps in three rounds. You need to manufacture one winner and you can see right off the bat that it cannot be manufactured in ♦s or ♣s. However, you **CAN** set up the ♠8.

Lead the ♠10. East must win with his ♠J. Let's say he plays a ♣. Win with dummy's ♣A and play the ♠9, discarding a small ♣. East will take his ♠Q and cash a ♣ trick, but then must let you back in. You enter dummy with the ♦A and discard your ♦ loser on the good ♠8.

It is extra nice when the opponents hand you a contract.

You cannot make 10 tricks unless East's opening lead is a ♠.

Your first bid is easy, you say 1♥. But what do you say after partner's 2♥ response?

You have 18 points and partner has 6-10. Doing the math, you total 24-28.

You want to make a bid that will tell partner to bid game if he has 9-10, but will stop at 3♥ if he only has 6-7. Lots of players will bid 3♥ with this hand to make just that invitation. There's nothing wrong with that bid.

But there is an improvement. Bid 3♣ instead. Partner knows you aren't showing him a ♣ suit, why would you do that after agreeing on ♥s? What it means is "Partner I'm inviting you to bid the game if you have maximum, but if your decision is close decide based on ♣s, the suit I could use help in." It is called a

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A J 6 4

♥ 7 5

♦ A K 7 4 2

♣ 6 2

♠ 10

♥ K 9 8 3

♦ Q J 9 5

♣ Q 10 7 4



♠ K Q 9 8 7 5 2

♥ A 4

♦ 6 3

♣ A 8

♠ 3

♥ Q J 10 6 2

♦ 10 8

♣ K J 9 5 3

West	North	East	South
1♦	Pass	1♠	Pass
2♠	Pass	3♣	Pass
3♦	Pass	4NT	Pass
5♥	Pass	6♠	
All Pass			

6♠ by East

you aren't bidding a ♣ suit, he knows you have already agreed on ♠s. He will take you to be showing first round control in ♣s, probably the ♣A.

Partner bids 3♦.

Partner's 3♦ is a control bid showing the ♦A. Do not even consider that he is trying to get back to ♦s, you both know that your suit is ♠s.

NOW you use Blackwood, knowing you are not in danger of losing two quick ♦s.

Partner replies 5♥, showing two Aces.

Your side has all the Aces but don't get greedy. Remember that partner made a minimum bid at his second turn. He couldn't have two Aces and three Kings.

So you bid the small slam.

East plays 6♠. South leads the ♥Q.

East plays 6♠. South leads the ♥Q.

Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 0 : ♣ 1 : Total = 2

Too bad partner didn't have either ♥K or ♣K. But since he didn't you will just have to establish the ♦ suit.

You pull trumps in one round with your ♠K. Play ♦ A K, then ruff a ♦. if both defenders follow then both dummy's ♦s are good and you will make 7. However, it is more likely that ♦s will split 4-2, in which case you return to dummy with the ♠J and ruff the fourth ♦. Back to dummy with the ♠A and play the now-established ♦7, discarding either your ♥ or ♣ loser.

Establishing a long side suit in dummy is one of the basic ways to eliminate a loser.

In this hand you could not be defeated unless the ♦s split 5-1.

You don't quite have the strength for a jump-shift, and in any case sometimes it is better to proceed slowly. So you respond 1♠, knowing partner must bid again.

He does bid again, surprising you when he says 2♠.

All of a sudden your hand has become gigantic. Never mind points, you have only 5 possible losers in your hand and partner has opened the bidding. Surely he can take care of a few of them.

You want to try for slam. **DO NOT BID**

BLACKWOOD! With two quick losers in ♦s you would not know what to do if Partner showed only one Ace. You wouldn't know whether the defense could take the first two ♦ tricks or not. A better approach is to use a control bid.

So you bid 3♣. Partner will absolutely know that